Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

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On-Campus Employment

F-1 and J-1 undergraduate and graduate degree students may begin on-campus employment at the beginning of their first semester at USC.

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How Many Hours Can Students Work Per Week?

On-campus employment for F-1 and J-1 students is limited to **20 hours per week during the fall and spring semesters** and up to **40 hours per week during the summer term and official university breaks**.

F-1 and J-1 students may work on campus w ractical Training (CPT) or Pre-Completion Academic t interfere with academic progress.

E xample, during the fall and spring seme k o us n additional 20 hours per week of part-

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ON-CAMPUS JOB SEARCH RESOURCES

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Work-Study

International students are **not eligible** for Federal Work-Study positions, which are funded by the U.S. government and generally available only to U dy opportunities are commonly advertised as "

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below the minimum units listed above, provided they submit their SEVIS Final Semester Check to confirm eligibility with OIS.

- **Thesis/Dissertation or Qualifying Exam Stage:** Graduate students who register in thesis, dissertation or qualifying exam coursework (594/794/800) are considered to be enrolled full time, regardless of the unit value. An RCL is not required in these circumstances, and students remain eligible for on-campus employment.

*To work on campus and be paid through USC Payroll during their final semester, students must have their STARS report updated to confirm that they are in their final semester. Please note that this is a separate process from submitting the SEVIS Final Semester Check request to OIS. Updating the STARS report requires the student's academic advisor to apply the student's remaining courses toward their degree and enter a "degree check" in the Student Information System (SIS). This action prompts STARS to determine whether all graduation requirements have been met. It may take approximately 24 to 48 hours after the degree check is completed for USC Payroll Services to receive the updated information needed to process payroll paperwork.

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Off-Campus Employment That loyment

Immigration regulations allow international students to work at an off-campus location, if:

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employed during their time in F-1/J-1 student status, working without proper authorization is a serious violation of this student status. Please speak with an OIS advisor about any concerns.

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F-1 Student Employment

J-1 Student Employment

U.S. Taxes

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